

Namibia Investment Promotion & Development Board

Department: MSME Development, Innovation & Acceleration
Startup & Scale Division

NIPDB
Namibia Investment Promotion & Development Board
Office of the President

NIPDB Mandate

Investment Development, Promotion and Facilitation



MSME Development

Executive Team



NANGULA UAANDJA
Chief Executive Officer (CEO)



RICHWELL LUKONGA
Chief Operations Officer (COO)

Our Vision

To develop and implement strategic initiatives that complement other government efforts aimed at economic development with a focus to reduce unemployment.

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Executive Team



FRANCOIS VAN SCHALKWYK
Investments and New Ventures



MARGARETH GUSTAVO
Strategy and Branding

VACANT
MSME Development, Innovation and Acceleration



JESSICA HAUUANGA
Investor Experience, Retention and Aftercare



JULIA MUETUDHANA
Talent, Innovation and Productivity

Priority Sectors



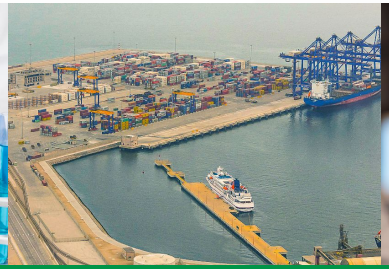
Renewable Energy



Food Industry



Chemicals & Basic Materials



Transport and Logistics



Services (Digital and Global Business)



Metals, Mining & Adjacent Industries



Machinery & Electronics



Technology & E-services



Tourism



Exploration (Mining and Oil & Gas)

Summary of NIPDB

Ultimately the NIPDB exists to unlock opportunities that enable a better quality of life for all Namibians. We do this by facilitating trust relationships to attract and retain sustainable investment for private sector-led and inclusive economic growth. As part of its statutory mandate, the Board also aims to improve Namibia's competitiveness score, develop the required skills for sustainable investments that lead to job creation, and create an enabling ecosystem for MSME's and startups to thrive and scale.

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NAMIBIAN
MSME & STARTUP LANDSCAPE

MSME & Startup Ecosystem in Namibia



MSMEs contribute ⅓ Labour Force (MSME Policy 2016)



MSMEs account for **12%** of GDP (MSME Policy, 2016)



Windhoek is ranked 616/700 cities globally

(Global Startup Ecosystem Index 2024)



Global Competitiveness Ranking **94/140** countries (World Economic Forum 2020)



National DIgital Strategy 2024 - 2028



Namibia's startup ecosystem is ranked 87/100 globally and **8/54 countries in Africa**



National Informal Economy, Startup and Entrepreneurship (NIESED) Policy public consultations held



Ease of Doing Business Ranking **104/190** countries (World Bank 2020)

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NIPDB Focus Areas



Access to Finance



Information



Capacitation



Scaling



Startups



Building Networks



Policy advocacy



Market access and Export Promotion



NAMIBIAN
STARTUP SPACE

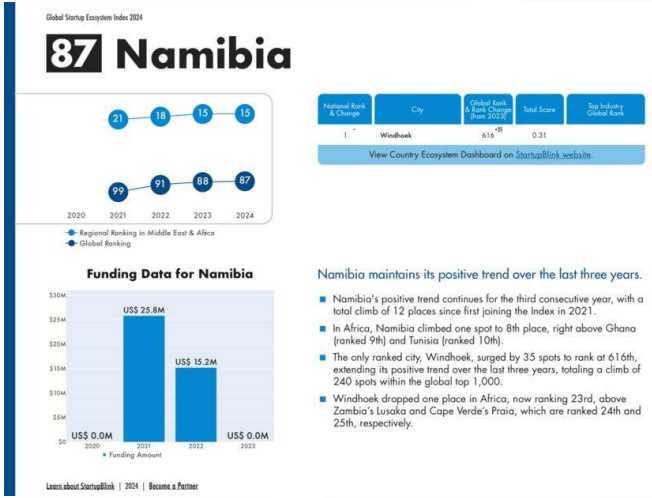
Building on Startup Namibia's Success



Global Startup Ecosystem Index

2nd, 8th & 87th

Southern Africa, Africa & Global



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Opportunities and Challenges

Namibia's Rich Potential

- Natural Resources
- Young and tech-savvy population
- Emerging & Untapped Ecosystem
- Strategic geographic location as a gateway to Southern Africa

Existing Challenges

- Limited Startup Funding and Infrastructure
- Windhoek Centralized Ecosystem
- Insufficient Skilled Talent
- Limited risk-taking capital and culture



Global Trend

- Startups as engines of innovative economic growth strategies and job creation
- Rapid technological advancements creating new opportunities
- Increased focus on sustainable and social impact startups

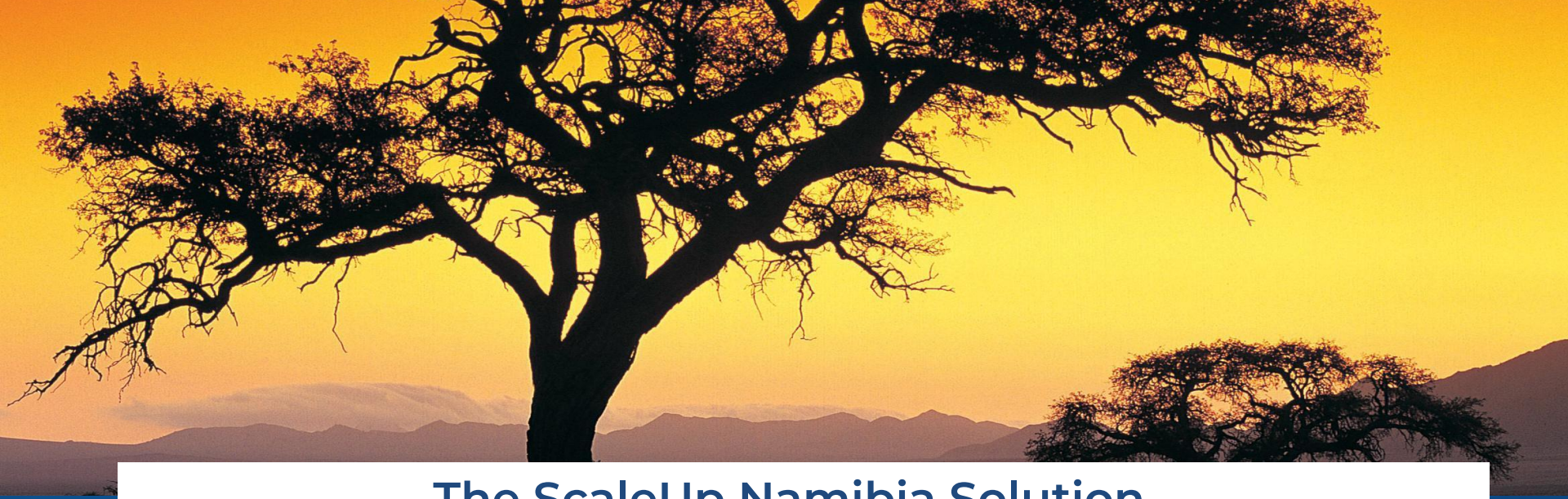
Success Stories: Benchmark

- Startup Tunisia
- Startup Nigeria
- Startup India
- Startup Portugal

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The ScaleUp Namibia Solution

ScaleUp Namibia’s Vision

Fostering an Entrepreneurial, Innovation & Technological Ecosystem

ScaleUp Namibia is a strategic intervention to address existing challenges and propel the growth and sustainability of Namibia's startup ecosystem.



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Nail to Scale

What will ScaleUp Namibia do and why is it Important?

Support the transformation of innovative ideas into investor-ready ventures by cultivating synergies among stakeholders in Namibia's startup ecosystem, and enhancing Namibia's global startup reputation.



Network of Ecosystem Enablers (How)

A Local Network with Global Ambitions:

- **Connect:** Bridging the gap between innovation hubs
- **Collaborate:** Working together to achieve shared goals
- **Communicate:** Open and transparent exchange of information
- **Co-create:** Building a network through collective effort
- **Unlocking Funding Pipelines:** Access to markets and funding

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SCALEUP NAMIBIA

SOUTHERN AFRICA INNOVATION COLLECTIVE

AFRILABS

The Future of African Innovation:

- **Fostering** an interconnecting across Africa network that empowers African innovation
- **Addressing** continental challenges and unlocking opportunities
- **Collaboration** between hubs in the region, sharing resources and expertise and joint initiatives and programs

Smart & Strategic Partnership (How)

National Commission on Research, Science & Technology (NCRST)

Coordinator: Southern Africa Innovation Collective (SAIC)

National Innovation Framework that will include:

- Accreditation & Certification Process
- Infrastructure: Tech Stations
- STI & R&D Stakeholder Coordination & Relationship Management
- Resource Administration & Mobilization

Namibia Investment Promotion & Development Board

Coordinator: ScaleUp Namibia (SUN)

ScaleUp Namibia Framework that will include:

- Startup Ecosystem Support
- Startup Stakeholder Coordination & Relationship Management
- Resource Administration & Mobilization
- Ecosystem Mapping
- Data Tracking & M&E

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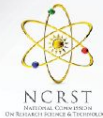


Milestones: Step by Step Approach

SCALEUP NAMIBIA FORMATION WORKSHOP

Thursday, 30 May 2024 | Investment House































Workshop Participants

1. **Academia**
2. **Financiers & Investors**
3. **Public & Private Sectors**
4. **Regulators**
5. **Startups, Incubators & Accelerators**

Key Findings

Promote and Facilitate Investment

- Hubs need to better showcase the benefits for corporates.
- A framework is needed to align hub goals with corporate interests.

Data Challenges:

- Lack of unified data among hubs.
- Proposed: A tracking tool for startup progress with public access.

Resource Competition:

- Hubs are competing for limited resources.
- Governance issues and lack of government support.



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Key Findings

Diverse Objectives:

- Hubs have varied objectives causing misalignment.
- Need to identify and resolve contradictions.



Success Metrics:

- Different definitions of success among stakeholders.
- Focus on societal benefits and accessible data.

Collaboration:

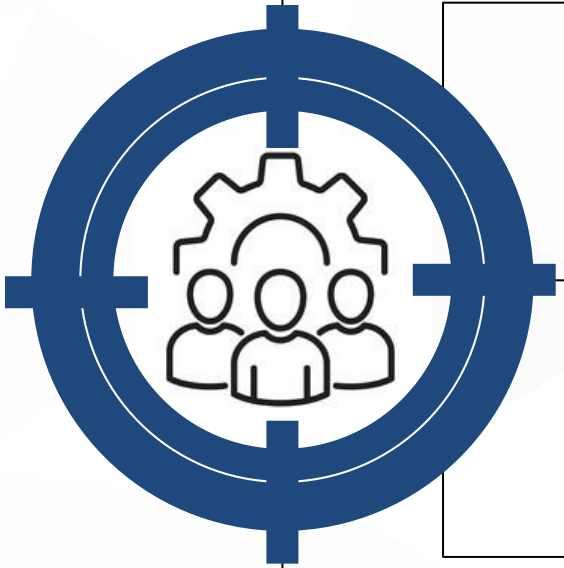
- Enthusiasm for collaboration but challenges with overlap.

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Identified Pillars

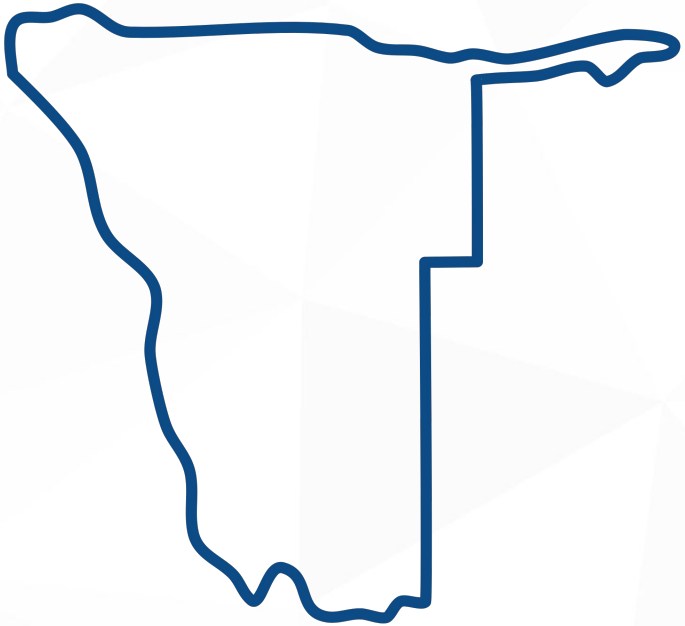
1. **Cultivating a Robust Pipeline of Skilled Talent and Supportive Infrastructure**
2. **Fostering a Supportive Ecosystem** through funding, networking and promotion
3. **Policy & Regulation:** Advocate for policy changes to create a favourable environment.
4. **Finance:** Address the funding gap faced by startups.
5. **Global Footprint & Competitiveness:** Enhance Namibia's startup presence on the world stage.

SUN's Roadmap: Activation & Implementation



- **Phase 1: Concept Development Phase & Identification of Stakeholders**
- **Phase 2: Formation Workshop**
- **Phase 3: Inauguration Phase**
- **Phase 4: Digital Footprint**
- **Phase 5: Awareness, Awareness and Activation**

Collaboration Equals Success



By working together, we can create a dynamic and thriving startup ecosystem in Namibia.

MEMBERS

- Acelera
- Afrisource Innovation Center Namibia
- Basecamp Business Incubator
- Co-creation Hub Namibia (CcHub Namibia)
- Global Entrepreneurship Network Namibia (GEN)
- Glowdow
- Impact Tank Namibia
- It Takes A Village
- Launch Namibia
- Mindsinaction
- Namibia Business Angels Network (NABAN)
- Namibia Innovation Hub (Ni!H)
- Namibia Investment Promotion and Development Board (NIPDB)
- Namibia University of Science and Technology: Namibia Business Innovation Institute (NBII)
- National Commission Research Science and Technology (NCRST)
- PyCon Namibia
- RLabs Namibia
- University of Namibia: Center for Innovation and Development

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FUTURE
VISION FOR NAMIBIA

The future vision for Namibia's startup ecosystem is a self-sustaining powerhouse where innovation flourishes and global impact originates. By 2030, Namibia should be an African leader in nurturing startups, spawning multiple global startup giants and be a magnet for top talent, investment and knowledge.



Thank You

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